

Camping Chair — Buying Report (June 2026, v2)

For: Mix of car-camping / festivals / garden + occasional carrying. **Comfort is the #1 priority.** **Body:** 6 ft tall, **13 stone (~82.5 kg)**, with a **long torso relative to shorter legs**. **Wanted features:** reclining · padded headrest · footrest · cup holder/storage · padding/insulation. **Budget:** max **£200**.

v2 update: Re-weighted for the user's actual measurements. At ~82.5 kg, **weight capacity is a non-issue** (every chair here clears it with huge margin), so the heavy-duty 180–200 kg framing from v1 no longer applies — lighter, comfier chairs are back in play. The body shape (**long torso + short legs**) makes a **tall backrest** the priority and a **footrest** a real ergonomic benefit, not just a bonus.

v3 update — live Amazon.co.uk prices (accessed 22 Jun 2026): see the table below. Headline: the **Vango Hampton DLX + footstool comes to ~£111 all-in** (cheaper than estimated), and the **Nemo Stargaze is ~£250 on Amazon UK — over budget** (drop it for an Amazon purchase).

v4 update — recline mechanism + optional footrest: User currently has a **zero-gravity recliner** and finds its **twist-lock recline levers impractical**. Footrest is now a confirmed **must**, but wanted as an **option you deploy when you choose** (not always attached). This *reinforces* the top pick: the **Vango Hampton DLX** reclines via a **7-position frame (no twist-lock knobs)**, and its **Padded Footstool is a separate clip-on** you add only when you want your feet up. Steer away from zero-gravity chairs (they nearly all use the same twist-lock levers).

Your current chair & the recline mechanisms (why this matters)

You've got a **zero-gravity lounge**r with **twist-lock levers** on each armrest — you twist both to lock/release the recline. That's the pain point. Here's how the recline types compare, easiest-first:

Recline type	How it works	Verdict for you
Hands-free lean-back (Nemo Stargaze)	Just lean back, it holds your angle	Easiest of all — but ~£250, over budget
Multi-position frame (Vango Hampton DLX)	Lean/adjust the chair into 7 preset positions; hard armrests	No levers/knobs — fixes your gripe, in budget
Auto-rising lounge r (Outwell Catamarca Lounger)	Lean back and the footrest rises with you	Simple, footrest built-in (always there)
Slide/cam-lock (Outwell Acadia)	Lockable slide positions	Has a locking action — better than twist levers but not lever-free
Twist-lock zero-gravity (your current chair)	Twist both side levers to lock	What you're replacing — avoid

Live Amazon.co.uk prices (22 Jun 2026)

Item	Amazon price	Notes	Link (ASIN)
Vango Hampton DLX (standard, Excalibur)	£70.61	140 kg · 116 cm back · 7-pos recline · padded · headrest cushion	B081G5R3MD
Vango Hampton Padded Footstool	~£40 (RRP)	The leg support for your short legs. <i>Out of stock at Vango direct — check Amazon/Winfields stock</i>	B0BQCFK85K
→ Top-pick bundle (chair + footstool)	≈ £110.61	Tall back + recline + headrest + footrest + padded, ~£90 under budget	—
Outwell Catamarca Lounger (Black)	£73.99	Built-in auto footrest + recline + cup holder · 125 kg	B0BWJY8JNQ
Outwell Acadia (Black)	from £163.99	Padded · recline · removable headrest · cup-holder side table · 150 kg	B084SDQ7QY
Helinox Sunset Chair (Black, w/ pockets)	£189.00 (RRP £239; other offers from £143.83)	Tall back + headrest flap · 1.56 kg · 145 kg · no recline/footrest	B09N2DFFLM
~~Nemo Stargaze Recliner Luxury~~ (Oxide)	~£250 over budget	Was my "comfort" pick — but Amazon UK price exceeds £200; only buy if you find the cheaper EVO-X variant elsewhere	B09PH6Q2L6

Amazon prices change frequently and vary by colourway — confirm at checkout. "Other offers from £143.83" on the Helinox = used/third-party sellers.

How your body shape changes the pick

- **Long torso** → **tall backrest is essential**. You need the back to reach up to your shoulders/neck. Aim for a back height of **~110 cm+** (or a headrest flap/cushion) so your upper back and head are supported, not floating above the chair.
- **Shorter legs** → **a footrest is genuinely worth it**. With shorter legs, an ordinary seat leaves your feet dangling or your calves unsupported. A **footrest/leg rest** lets your legs rest properly — this is the single biggest comfort upgrade for your shape.
- **Avoid a deliberately high seat and a very deep seat**. A high seat (e.g. Helinox Chair One XL's 47 cm "easy to stand up" seat) leaves short legs dangling; a deep seat pan presses behind your knees. A **moderate seat height (~40–45 cm)** with a footrest, or a slightly lower seat, suits you better.
- **Capacity: ignore it**. Anything rated 110 kg+ is fine — don't pay extra for 180–200 kg ratings you'll never use.

The ideal chair for you = TALL BACK + FOOTREST + RECLINE, in a comfy padded package.

My pick for you: Vango Hampton DLX (£95) + matching footrest

The standard **Hampton DLX** (not the extra-wide "Grande" — you don't need the 59 cm girth or 180 kg rating now) is the best fit for your shape and brief:

Spec	Detail	Why it fits you
Back height	116 cm (tall)	Supports your long torso up to the shoulders/neck
Recline	7 positions	Sit upright for food, lie back to relax
Headrest	Adjustable cushion (headrest/lumbar)	Extra upper-back/neck support
Footrest	Separate clip-on footstool (~£40)	Clips on <i>only when you want</i> your feet up, folds flat — exactly the "footrest if I choose" you asked for, and far better than your current twist-lever lounger
Padding	Padded seat + back, steel frame	Max comfort, year-round
Capacity / weight	140 kg / ~5.9 kg	Huge margin over your 82.5 kg; fine for car + short carries
Price	£95 + footrest ≈ £115–125 total	

Why it wins: it's the cheapest way to get a genuinely **tall, padded, reclining** chair **with a matching footrest** — the exact combination your body shape calls for — and the whole setup lands around £120, leaving budget to spare. In stock on Vango UK (unlike the often-sold-out Grande).

The three tiers (re-weighted for you)

Budget — Outwell Catamarca Lounger · ~£54–80

The cheapest chair that already has a tall back AND a built-in footrest — a natural fit for your shape.

Feature	Has it?
Back height	116 cm (tall — good for long torso)
Recline	dining → full lounger
Footrest	built-in, rises automatically as you lean back
Cup holder	mesh holder
Padding	sling fabric — add a £10–15 insulated seat pad
Capacity / weight	125 kg (ample) · ~6 kg

Best for: maximum ergonomic fit for the least money. The auto-rising footrest directly solves the short-leg dangle, and the tall back suits your torso. Add a fleece seat pad and you've effectively got the full feature set for under £80. Buy the **Lounger** (footrest + recline), *not* the plain Catamarca / Catamarca XL armchairs (£25/£43, no recline/footrest).

Mid — Vango Hampton DLX + footrest · ~£115–125 *top pick (details above)*

Padded · tall back · recline · headrest · footrest add-on · ample capacity. The all-round sweet spot for your shape and budget.

Best under £200 — comfort-led, pick by use

Route A — premium comfort that you can carry: Nemo Stargaze EVO-X · ~£166

Feature	Detail
Recline	✗ swinging auto-recline — suspended seat finds your angle hands-free
Headrest	adjustable padded headrest, "supports a wide range of heights" (good for a long torso)
Cup holder	two integrated holders
Footrest	none (legs can dangle — less ideal for short legs unless you add a small stool)
Padding	cool mesh (breathable, not warm)
Capacity / weight	136 kg · 2.86 kg (light enough to carry)

Best for: the most luxurious *comfort experience* and the lightest "best" option for your mixed/carry use. The suspended swing is superb for a long torso. **Caveat for your legs:** no footrest, so pair it with a tiny packable footstool if dangling bothers you; and the mesh isn't warm.

Route B — tallest back + plush, mostly car: Outwell Acadia · £165 Padded, adjustable + removable headrest, lockable recline (back 100–114 cm), side table + cup holder, 150 kg. No footrest (add a clip-on). Heaviest (8.4 kg) — best when you're mostly car-based and want the plushest seat.

Packable tall-back alternative — Helinox Sunset (£150) / Savanna (£200): Savanna has the tallest back (112 cm) + headrest pocket; Sunset is 97 cm + headrest flap, just 1.6 kg. Brilliant build and carry weight, and capacity is irrelevant now — but **no recline, no footrest**, so they're comfort-from-geometry rather than the lie-back-with-legs-up experience your shape benefits from.

Feature scorecard (re-ranked for your body shape)

Chair	Price	Back height	Recline	Headrest	Footrest	Cup holder	Padding	Carry wt	Fit for you
Vango Hampton DLX + footrest	~£115–125	116 cm	7-pos	•	add-on	clip-on	✗	5.9 kg	Best all-round
Outwell Catamarca Lounger	£54–80	116 cm	•	•	built-in	•	{+pad}	6 kg	Best value / ergonomics
Nemo Stargaze EVO-X	~£166	tall + headrest	✗ swing	•	✗	•	✗ mesh	2.86 kg	Best comfort + carry
Outwell Acadia	£165	100–114 cm						8.4 kg	Plushest, car-based
Helinox Savanna	£200	112 cm		pocket				1.9 kg	Tall back, ultralight
Helinox Sunset	£150	97 cm	fixed	flap				1.6 kg	

Chair	Price	Back height	Recline	Headrest	Footrest	Cup holder	Padding	Carry wt	Fit for you
									Lightest tall-back

= add as a cheap accessory.

Complete-the-setup accessories

- **Footrest** (the big one for your legs): Vango Hampton matching footrest (~£20–30); or a universal/ packable clip-on leg rest (Decathlon Quechua leg rest ~£17). For the Nemo, a small folding footstool.
- **Seat pad** (warmth/cushion): fleece or insulated pad, £10–15 — turns the Catamarca Lounger or any mesh chair into a plush, year-round seat.
- **Cup holder**: clip-on ~£5–8 if your chair lacks one.

What you can now ignore from v1

- Heavy-duty 180–200 kg chairs (Outwell Grand Canyon XL, Vango Hampton **Grande** DLX) — **overkill at 82.5 kg**, and the extra-wide seats can feel sloppy for your frame. The standard Hampton DLX fits better.
- The "high seat to stand up easily" advice — that suited a *tall-legged* user; for your **shorter legs**, a moderate seat + footrest is more comfortable.
- Capacity warnings on the Quechua (110 kg), Nemo Moonlite (113 kg), Alpkit/Robens (120 kg) — **all now fine for you**, so judge them purely on comfort/back height instead.

Decision shortcut

- **Best all-round for your shape (tall back + footrest + padded recline), great value** → Vango Hampton DLX £95 + footrest
- **Cheapest chair that already nails the ergonomics** → Outwell Catamarca Lounger £54–80 + seat pad
- **Most luxurious + lightest to carry** → Nemo Stargaze — *but ~£250 on Amazon UK (over budget)*; only if you find the cheaper EVO-X variant at a specialist retailer
- **Plushest, mostly-car option** → Outwell Acadia £165

Caveats / confidence

- Prices fluctuate; confirm at checkout. High-confidence (read direct): Vango Hampton DLX £95, Outwell Catamarca £25 / XL £43, Helinox Sunset £149.95 / Savanna £199.95, Nemo Stargaze EVO-X ~£166, Outwell Acadia £165.

- **Verify before buying:** the price of the Vango Hampton **footrest** accessory (not published — check at point of sale); that you're getting the Catamarca **Lounger** (footrest) not the armchair; current stock on the Hampton DLX.
- Back-height figures are manufacturer specs; if possible, sit in one at a Go Outdoors / Decathlon to confirm the back reaches your shoulders.

Key sources

- Vango Hampton DLX + footrest: vango.co.uk/hampton-dlx-chair
- Outwell Catamarca Lounger / Acadia: outwell.com/en-gb/ecommerce/camping-furniture · millets.co.uk
- Nemo Stargaze EVO-X: nemoequipment.com/products/stargaze-reclining-camp-chair · valleyandpeak.co.uk
- Helinox Sunset/Savanna: helinox.co.uk/products/sunset-chair · [/savanna-chair](https://helinox.co.uk/products/savanna-chair)
- Roundups: livefortheoutdoors.com/camping/accessories/best-camping-chairs · outdoorsmagic.com/article/best-camping-chairs